

on PLI, where there is a focus on stationary energy storage.

Q: Do you believe that the supply chain weaknesses across renewables are posing a big barrier to energy transition? What will be the role of the private sector in removing some of those hurdles now?

KAPIL MAHESHWARI, PRESIDENT, NEW ENERGY, RELIANCE INDUSTRIES LTD:

We have been talking just on the electricity side of the energy transition, which is only 30-35 per cent. Instead of calling it round-the-clock always, let's look at it in terms of dispatchable power. We really need to devise our projects and policies in accordance with that. On the supply chain side of it, you have seen an immense response on both the PLIs, where the government has asked for a good amount of local value addition. Let's take an example of solar PLI. There were players who bid for the entire value chain from sand, silica to ingot, wafer cell and module, whereas presently the country is only at cell and module. If you look at the ACC (Advanced Chemistry Cell) PLI, the participation was almost double. The kind of size that was announced at 50 gigawatt hours and the bids came in for 108 gigawatt hours. And with the kind of attention being given to energy density, the number of cycles and local value addition, even if everything falls in place, it will take its own time and we will face hurdles with geopolitical conditions like export bans on machinery from certain countries. So, while it poses challenges, it also provides an opportunity—can we develop these things on our own? Even others have taken time, so why are we in such a hurry that we want to do it today? I think we have all the capabilities present in India, be it financing, talent, engineering and



(From left) Sakshi Batra, Associate Editor and Anchor, Business Today TV; Amit Jain, Co-founder and MD, CES (India), and President, India Energy Storage Alliance (IESA); Kapil Maheshwari, President, Natural Resources & Chemicals (ENRC), KPMG in India; and Rajneesh Shrotriya, CTO, ST

the materials to do all that and the willpower as well.

Q: We usually say that the supply chains are as strong as the weakest link. So we rely on imports. We also rely on the growing need for skilful workers and the domestic manufacturing capacities that are untapped so far. Can all of these make the clean energy industry really vulnerable to production shortages, trade disruptions and even

natural disasters, going forward?

ANISH DE, GLOBAL HEAD, ENERGY, NATURAL RESOURCES & CHEMICALS (ENRC), KPMG IN INDIA:

That's not the only thing that will disrupt this industry. The only thing is that the industry will disrupt itself. So, hydrogen in one form will disrupt hydrogen in another form. So, we need to be ready for that disruption, and that's something that needs to be recognised. This question is coming from a very conventional lens, but if you look at the innovation